

Ontario Autism Program: Workforce Capacity Fund

Sector Innovation Stream

Application Form

Instructions

Before you apply

Read the entire Application Guidelines and the Applicant Checklist to ensure that you are eligible for funding.

You should also read the [ministry's guidelines for OAP Core Clinical Services](#) to make sure that you understand the ministry's requirements and expectations for OAP Core Clinical Service delivery.

What you need to apply

You may need to upload the following documents at the end of the form.

1. **Proof of legal status:** document that proves your organization's legal status, such as articles of incorporation or registered business applications.
2. **Financial statements:** your organization's most recent review engagement or annual audited financial statements prepared by a Licensed Public or Chartered Professional Accountant including: an income statement, balance sheet and notes to statements. For review engagements, a professional assurance that the financial statements are free of material misstatements and for audited financial statements, the auditor's opinion on the statements must be included.

Submitting your application form

You must email your completed application form to OAP_CFA@ontario.ca by **September 19, 2021 at 11:59pm EST**. We will not accept applications submitted after this deadline.

You can submit your application in English or French.

Need more information?

Contact the ministry at OAP_CFA@ontario.ca

A. Eligibility Checklist

Organization Type

I am applying on behalf of the following organization type (please select one of the following options):

- ☐ Children's service provider (public or private)
- ☐ Indigenous-led organization¹
- ☐ Post-secondary institution (must be in partnership with children's service providers)
- ☐ Professional association or regulatory college (must be in partnership with children's service providers)
- ☐ Not-for-profit organization or community group (must be in partnership with children's service providers)

Other Requirements

- ☐ My organization has legal status (e.g., organizations established by or under legislation; federally or provincially incorporated; band councils established under the *Indian Act*; or other Indigenous-led organizations that are incorporated).
- ☐ My organization is not in default of the terms and conditions of any grant or loan agreement with any ministry or the Government of Ontario.
- ☐ My organization has or is able to obtain at least \$2 million commercial general liability insurance coverage, before the legal service agreement is executed.

¹ An **Indigenous-led organization** is an organization that serves an Indigenous community and whose governance reflects the composition of that community. This may include:

- not-for-profit and for-profit corporations, registered charities, and other public bodies that are Indigenous-led; and,
- Indigenous communities (inclusive of First Nations, Métis and Inuit communities).

B. Applicant Information

Organization Information	
Legal Name	Operating Name (if different from legal name)
Are you registered in Transfer Payment Ontario? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ I don't know	
Business Address	
City/Town	Postal Code
Mailing Address (if different from Business Address)	
City/Town	Postal Code
Organizational Contact	
Provide one key contact for the person who will be responsible for grant administration and correspondence with the ministry. The contact must: • be staff or an organizational appointee – not an external grant writer or external project manager; and, • have signing authority for the organization.	
Given Name	Surname
Position Title	Preferred language of communication ☐ French ☐ English
Telephone	E-mail

C. Organizational Capacity

1. Describe your organization's experience, expertise, and future role with respect to the OAP core clinical services workforce and service system.

(2400 characters limit)

-
2. Describe your organization's financial management practices. How does your organization develop, approve, and monitor annual budgets?

(1200 characters limit)

-
3. For each of the three areas below, describe the skills and relevant experience of the key staff who will lead this project, as well as how long they have been with your organization.

- Financial management
- Program administration
- Human resources

(1800 characters limit)

D. Consortia

For projects led by a group of organizations / consortium, one organization must be appointed as the 'lead organization.' The lead organization prepares the application form and manages all aspects of the grant, including the service agreement and reporting.

4. Are you applying on behalf of a consortium?

☐ Yes.

If you selected yes, please answer questions 5 and 6.

☐ No

5. For each member of the consortium, list:

- The organization's name
- The organization's role on the project
- Name and title of a key contact person who will represent the organization on this project

(600 characters limit)

6. How will consortium members work together to achieve project goals?

(800 characters limit)

E. Project Scope

7. What type of OAP core clinical service will be the focus of your project (select all that apply)?

- ☐ Applied Behaviour Analysis
- ☐ Speech-Language Pathology
- ☐ Occupational Therapy
- ☐ Mental health services (e.g., counselling and/or psychotherapy)

8. In what ministry service region will you deliver this project? (Select all that apply)

To determine the service region, see the map and descriptions on the [ministry's website](#).

- ☐ North
- ☐ West
- ☐ East
- ☐ Central
- ☐ Toronto

9. What communities are you targeting with this project?

We are looking for a list of the municipalities and/or regional districts where you intend to deliver this project. Be as specific and concise as possible. A description of the area is not needed.

(800 characters limit)

10. Does the project, or any of its activities, have a specific focus on any of the following priority groups?
(Select all that apply)

- ☐ Families living in Northern Ontario
- ☐ Families living rural and remote communities
- ☐ Indigenous families
- ☐ Francophone families
- ☐ The project is not specifically focused on any of the above groups.

F. Project Description

11. What is the workforce or service system challenge that you are trying to solve?

Be as specific as possible. As part of your response, provide evidence on the need for this project.

(2000 characters limit)

12. What is the solution that you would like to develop and test to respond to this challenge?

Be as specific as possible and identify the tangible goods or services (“deliverables”) that will be produced and delivered within 12 months as a result of this funding. Examples of deliverables could include (but are not limited to):

- A program
- Training, workshops or a conference
- A toolkit
- Creation of a committee or group
- A report

(4000 characters limit)

G. Project Impact

13. What objective will your project contribute towards (select all that apply)?

- ☐ **Workforce:** build, retain, and grow the OAP Core Clinical Services workforce.
- ☐ **Organizations:** increase the skills and knowledge of service provider organizations to operate within a consumer-driven market.
- ☐ **Markets:** increase market presence of OAP Core Clinical Services and strengthen service delivery models that improve service access for families.

14. How will your project address the selected objective(s)?

(800 characters limit)

15. Who will benefit from this project, and how?

In your response, consider individuals, organizations, and communities. Quantify your answer where possible (e.g., number of families, number of organizations, number of staff).

(1200 characters limit)

16. How will outcomes from the project be sustained beyond the funded project period?

(800 characters limit)

H. Project Implementation

17. Describe how you will implement this project.

Your response must include:

- Number and type of staff required for each deliverable
- Key milestones for each deliverable
- Basic timelines for each deliverable

Note that your proposed activities must take place over the course of 12 months.

(2000 characters limit)

18. Describe at least three potential challenges that could prevent you from completing this project, and how you would address these challenges.

For example: inability to find qualified staff, going over budget, activity delays.

(1800 characters limit)

19. Describe how you will work other organizations, community partners, and families to enhance project outcomes and support shared learning and growth.

(1200 characters limit)

I. Project Monitoring and Evaluation

20. What evaluation techniques will you use to track progress and measure the success of this project?

(800 characters limit)

21. List at least five datapoints that you will track throughout the project

For example: number of families served, number of staff trained, number of workshop participants.

(1200 characters limit)

J. Budget

Provide your budget estimate, using the template below. If your application is successful, the budget reported below will be reviewed and approved by the ministry prior to the finalization of the service agreement.

Tips for completing this template:

- Make sure your total budget is between \$25,000 and \$300,000.
- Only include expenses that you would like funded through this grant program.
- If the row does not correspond to your expenses, leave it blank.
- Include applicable taxes in your cost estimates, such as HST and GST.
- Provide a clear breakdown of costs in the “funding breakdown” column. Read the Sample Budget in the Appendix to see what we are looking for.
- Be realistic and cost-effective. We will be looking for value-for-money when we evaluate your application form.

Budget Item	Description	Funding Breakdown (Number of units and cost per unit)	Funding Request (\$)
Staff Salaries	Wages (including mandatory employment-related costs and employee benefits) for staff who will be delivering the project.		
Purchased Services	Cost of any services of consultants / contractors / subject experts specifically relating to the delivery of the project.		
Communications	Cost of any communications tasks related to your project, including virtual or in-person meeting expenses, as well as any marketing and promotional activities.		
Supplies and Equipment	Cost of supplies and equipment that you need to rent or purchase to deliver the project.		
Travel	Cost of essential travel activities that are required to deliver your project. The ministry will cover the following expenses: • Travel by car (\$0.41 per km) • Travel by plane, train, or bus (estimated cost of economy class ticket) • Accommodation (maximum of \$100 per night) We expect applicants to use the most practical and economical means of travel. Where possible, we encourage you to consider socially distant alternatives.		
Other	Any project costs not captured in other rows (please describe the item in the Funding Breakdown column).		
Sub-total Total funding request, not including Allocated Central Administration.			
Allocated Central Administration	Overhead and administration costs directly associated with the funded project. You can request a maximum of 10% of your budget (10.5% if you are in Northern Ontario) to cover these costs. These do not include the direct costs to run or deliver the project, such as staff or equipment, but include a portion of regular operational expenses that can be attributed specifically to this project.		
Total Funding Request, including Allocated Central Administration (Must be between \$25,000 and \$300,000)			

K. Supporting Documents

You will need to attach the documents listed below to this application form.

Exceptions:

- If you have already uploaded these documents to your Transfer Payment Ontario account ("Organization Documents" page within the View/Update Organization menu), you do not need to attach these documents.
- If you are applying on behalf of a First Nation, you do not need to attach these documents. However, the ministry may request to see your most recent audited financial statements if they are not available online.

22. Have you uploaded the following to Transfer Payment Ontario?

Proof of legal status: document that proves your organization's legal status, such as articles of incorporation or registered business applications.

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you selected no, please attach a copy of this document to this application form by clicking the 'Attach' button.

☐ Not Applicable. I am applying on behalf of a First Nation.

Financial Statements: your organization's most recent review engagement or annual audited financial statements prepared by a Licensed Public or Chartered Professional Accountant including: an income statement, balance sheet and notes to statements. For review engagements, a professional assurance that the financial statements are free of material misstatements and for audited financial statements, the auditor's opinion on the statements must be included.

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you selected no, please attach a copy of this document to this application form by clicking the 'Attach' button.

☐ Not Applicable. I am applying on behalf of a First Nation.

L. Declaration/Signing

The ministry reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to fund or not fund any particular funding request or project for which an application is submitted. The decision to fund all or part of an Applicant request will depend on its fit with the program priorities, evaluation criteria and the overall demand for funding through the OAP Workforce Capacity Fund.

Applicants are expected to comply with the Ontario Human Rights Code (the “Code”) and all other applicable laws (www.ohrc.on.ca/en/ontario-human-rights-code). Failure to comply with the letter and spirit of the Code will render the Applicant ineligible for a grant and, in the event a grant is made, liable to repay the grant in its entirety at the request of the ministry.

Applicants should be aware that Government of Ontario institutions are bound by the *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act, R.S.O. 1990, c.F.31* (www.ontario.ca/laws/statute/90f31), as amended from time to time, and that any information provided to them in connection with this application may be subject to disclosure in accordance with that Act. Applicants are advised that the names and addresses of organizations receiving grants, the amount of the grant awards, and the purpose for which grants are awarded is information made available to the public.

Applicants are also expected to be free of conflict of interest (real or perceived) with respect to this application. "Conflict of Interest" includes, but is not limited to, any situation or circumstance where in relation to the OAP Workforce Capacity Fund application process, the Applicant has an unfair advantage or engages in conduct, directly or indirectly, that may give it an unfair advantage, including:

1. having, or having access to, information in the preparation of its submission that is confidential to the Ontario government and not available to other organizations;
2. communicating with any person with a view to influencing decision-making for the OAP Workforce Capacity Fund; or
3. engaging in conduct that compromises, or could be seen to compromise, the integrity or competitiveness of the OAP Workforce Capacity Fund application process and render that process non-competitive and unfair.

Declaration

The Applicant hereby certifies as follows:

- a. The information provided in this application is true, correct and complete in every respect.
- b. I have read and understand the information contained in the Application Form and the Application Guidelines.
- c. I understand that even if I have submitted a complete application and may have met all the eligibility and selection criteria, I may not be selected to receive funding or may not receive the amount of funding identified in my proposed budget.

- d. I understand that the ministry may:
- Seek clarification and supplementary information from me at any time during the selection process;
 - Make changes to the application process, waive any element of the application process or cancel this application process at any time; and,
 - Provide funding to any organization for similar services, outside of this application process.
- e. I understand any funding commitment will be provided by way of a transfer payment agreement signed by the ministry and will be subject to any terms or conditions set by the ministry, including reporting requirements.
- f. I understand that I am expected to comply with the Ontario Human Rights Code and all other applicable laws.
- g. I understand that the information contained herein can be used for the assessment of grant eligibility and for statistical reporting.
- h. I understand that the information contained in this application or submitted to the ministry in connection with the grant may be subject to disclosure under the *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act*.
- i. To the best of my knowledge and belief, no actual or potential conflict of interest exists with respect to the preparation and submission of this Application.
- j. I am an authorized signing officer for the Applicant.

Name and Title (please print)	Signature	Date
-------------------------------	-----------	------

Appendix: Sample Budget

Budget Item	Description	Funding Breakdown (number of units and cost per unit)	Funding Request (\$)
Staff Salaries	Wages (including mandatory employment-related costs and employee benefits) for staff who will be delivering the project.	1 FTE – Project Manager: Digital Specialist (\$30/hour x 40 hours/week x 26 weeks = \$24,700)	\$31,200
Purchased Services	Cost of any services of consultants / contractors / subject experts specifically relating to the delivery of the project.	- Strategic Planning Consultant: \$11,000 - Organizational consultation on human centered design - \$5,000 - Translation of Materials: \$6,000 - Digitizing records: \$5,000 - Online program design: \$2,000 - Website design: \$5,000	\$34,000
Communications	Cost of any communications tasks related to your project, including virtual or in-person meeting expenses, as well as any marketing and promotional activities.	- Online Platform usage (licensing): \$3,000 - Knowledge mobilization costs (video production): \$10,000 - Organizational training/facilitation: \$5,000 - Digital marketing and promotional costs: \$7,000	\$25,000
Supplies and Equipment	Cost of supplies and equipment that you need to rent or purchase to deliver the project.	- Art supply packs: \$10,000 - Equipment rental (6 sessions): \$4,000 - Health and safety supplies - \$2,500	\$16,500
Travel	Cost of essential travel activities that are required to deliver your project. The ministry will cover the following expenses: - Travel by car (\$0.41 per km) - Travel by plane, train, or bus (estimated cost of economy class ticket) - Accommodation (maximum of \$100 per night) We expect applicants to use the most practical and economical means of travel. Where possible, we encourage you to consider socially distant alternatives.	Employee program travel: 5,000km @ \$0.41 per km = \$2,050	\$2,050

Budget Item	Description	Funding Breakdown (number of units and cost per unit)	Funding Request (\$)
Other	Any project costs not captured in other rows (please describe the item in the Funding Breakdown column).		\$0
Sub-total Total funding request, not including Allocated Central Administration.			\$108,750
Allocated Central Administration	Overhead and administration costs directly associated with the funded project. You can request a maximum of 10% of your budget (10.5% if you are in Northern Ontario) to cover these costs. These do not include the direct costs to run or deliver the project, such as staff or equipment, but include a portion of regular operational expenses that can be attributed specifically to this project.		\$10,875
Total Funding Request, including Allocated Central Administration (Must be between \$25,000 and \$300,000)			\$119,625